End-user Release Note
2025 Common Operational Dataset on Population Statistics (COD-PS) Update, Sudan

Romesh Silva, Ph.D.[†], Mallika Snyder, Ph.D.[†], Faisal Abdallah Adam, Ph.D.[‡], Bruno Husquinet[‡]
[†] Population and Development Branch, Programme Division, New York, UNFPA
[‡] Sudan Country Office, Port Sudan, UNFPA

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These end-user release notes are designed to support end-users of the 2025 Sudan Common Operational Dataset on Population Statistics (COD-PS) Update. These notes support the effective and responsible use of this COD-PS update within the terms of its restricted release.

1. Summary Overview of 2024 COD-PS Update for Sudan

Release date of COD-PS update	August 18, 2025
Reference date of COD-PS update	1 July, 2025
Dates of Core Input Data	Population and Housing Census data and related estimates/projections (by CBS, IPC, US Census Bureau) — 2008 Census thematic analysis of fertility and mortality — 1993, 2008 UNHCR Registration Data — 1963 - December, 2024 IOM Displacement Tracking Matrix (DTM) Rounds -— latest round (Update 19) with reference date 25 June, 2025
Geographic disaggregation of COD-PS Update	National - ADM-0 area States - 18 ADM-1 areas Districts - 188 ADM-2 areas
Methodology	Cohort component projection methodology applied to census, mortality, fertility, and mobility data for ADM-1 geographic areas, then geographic disaggregation to ADM-2 areas using Iterative Proportional Fitting.
License	Publicly shared via OCHA Humanitarian Data Exchange

2. What is the 2025 COD-PS update for Sudan?

The 2025 Common Operational Dataset on Population Statistics (COD-PS)[1] update for Sudan is the best available set of subnational population projections, disaggregated by sex, 5-year age groups and down to ADM-2 geographic areas, that can support operational humanitarian response actions.

[1] The Common Operational Dataset on Population Statistics (COD-PS) is a set of up-to-date (i.e. reference date within the last year) subnational population projections, disaggregated by sex and age (standard 5-year demographic age groups) to the lowest geographic administrative level possible. The COD-PS is constructed according to “best available humanitarian data” standards and designed to support short-term humanitarian decision-making. The COD-PS is one of 3 mandatory common operational datasets, alongside common operational datasets on administrative boundaries and humanitarian caseloads, that are required in all operational humanitarian response countries by the United Nations. Ensuring the availability, quality and usability of the COD-PS is an institutional responsibility of the United Nations Population Fund (UNFPA) within the United Nations humanitarian system.

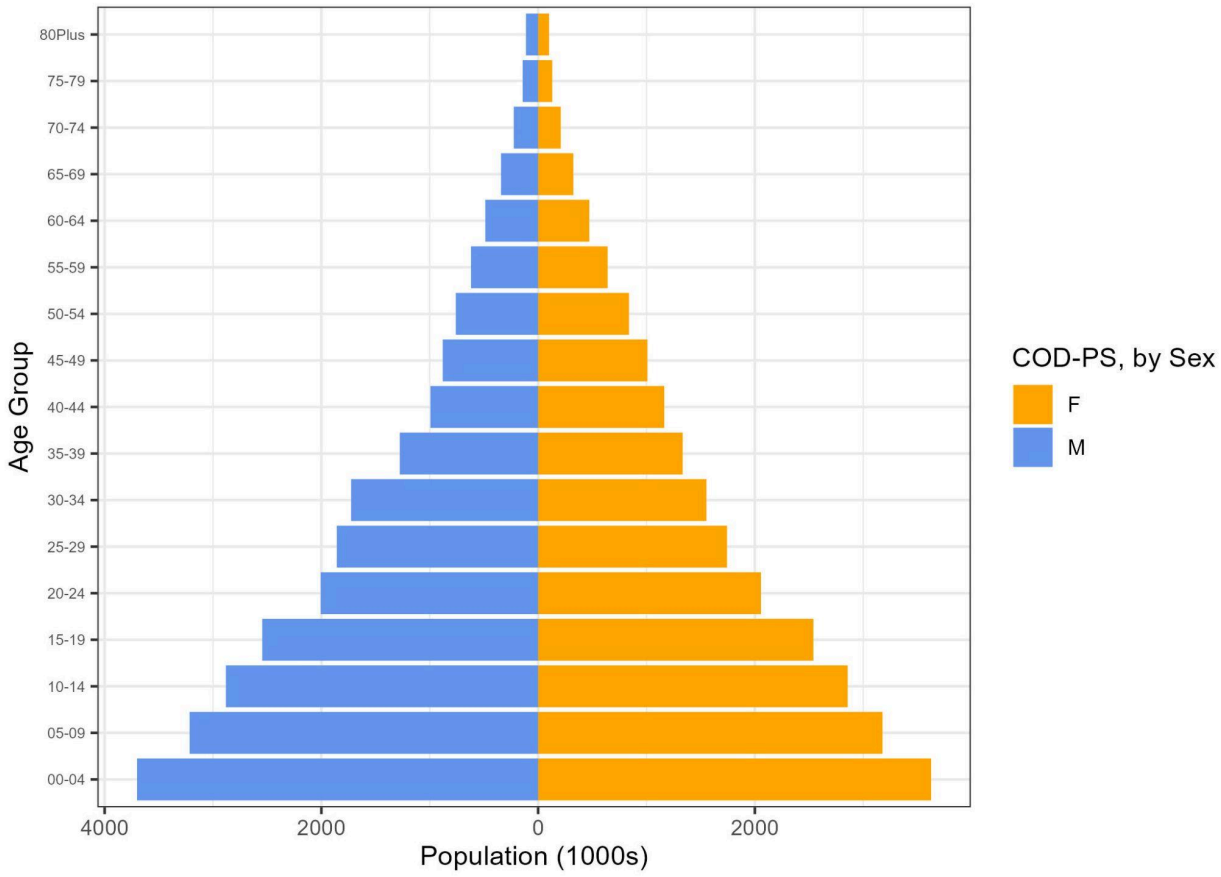
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The 2025 COD-PS update has a reference date of July, 2025. It uses the 2008 population and housing census data as a baseline population and projects the population forward to a reference date of July 2025, by using population data from censuses, surveys, UNHCR registration data, and IOM's Displacement Tracking Matrix to account for population change across states and districts of Sudan since the 2008 census.

3. What are some of the key insights from the 2025 COD-PS update in Sudan?

The 2025 COD-PS update projects the population of Sudan to be approximately 47.55 million persons, as of July 2025, comprising approximately 23.78 million females and 23.77 million males. as shown in Figure 1. In addition to the mortality and fertility effects of war and fragility, the largest component of population change in recent years has been conflict-related mobility – both across international borders and within the administrative boundaries of Sudan.

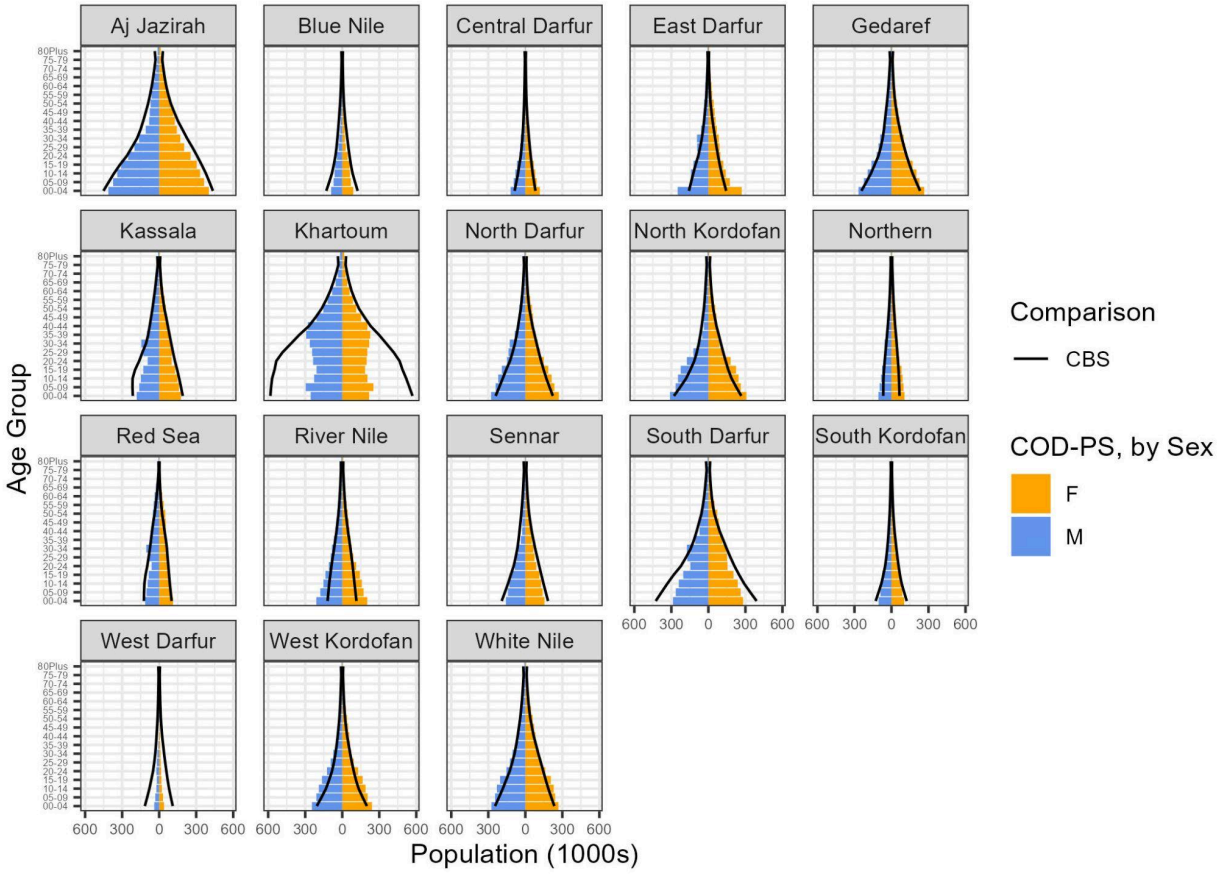
Figure 1: Projected Population of Sudan, by sex and age for ADM-0 geographic area - July, 2025 (2025 COD-PS Update)



This COD-PS update highlights the recent notable changes in population size and age/sex

structure across states and localities across Sudan and integrates data and evidence on population changes due to mortality and fertility inside of Sudan and mobility within and out of Sudan up to July, 2025. The substantial change across the 18 states of Sudan relative to the post-censal projections of the CBS highlight this in Figure 2, particularly for Khartoum and West Darfur.

Figure 2: Projected Population of Sudan, by sex and age for ADM-1 geographic areas - July, 2025 (2025 COD-PS Update)



4. What are some of the key advances from the 2025 COD-PS update in Sudan?

The 2025 COD-PS update for Sudan improves up on the earlier 2024 and 2022 COD-PS updates by

(1) Improved the crisis-related internal displacement among ADM-2 areas by incorporating new IOM DTM data as of June 2025;
(2) Improved the estimation of those who remain outside Sudan at the ADM-1 level by incorporating data on ADM-1 places of origin for refugees and asylum seekers with Sudan as a country of origin, from UNHCR as of July 2025;
(3) Drawing on the best available population and demographic data available in

Sudan including the UNICEF MICS Surveys of 2010 and 2014, thematic analyses of fertility and mortality by the Central Bureau of Statistics (Sudan), and ACLED data on conflict-related deaths, and

(4) Projecting the population forward from 2008 to July 2025 by sex and age for ADM-2 geographic areas of Sudan.

5. What has changed in terms of the 2025 COD-PS update for Sudan?

The previous COD-PS update for Sudan was released in July 2025. It reported a projected population size of 47.48 million persons within the internally recognized borders of Sudan, comprising approximately 23.89 million females and 23.59 million males, with a reference date of July 2025.

The 2025 COD-PS update for Sudan builds on the earlier COD-PS release, by projecting the population from the baseline 2008 census data to July 2025, accounting for the population changes due to fertility and mortality, accounting for (i.e. removing) those who remain outside Sudan, then accounting for the net mobility among regions within Sudan, to report projected district (ADM-2) level population counts by sex and age as of July 2025.

6. How can the 2025 COD-PS update for Sudan be used?

The COD-PS provides an updated set of subnational population projections, disaggregated by sex and five-year age groups, at ADM-2 geographical level. It directly accounts for recent population change due to mobility, mortality and fertility. Across Sudan, it is used to:

(1) Formulate Humanitarian Needs Overview (HNO) and Humanitarian Response Plan (HRP) across various sectors/clusters, and

(2) Guide local-level community-led recovery programmes.

7. Is there a difference in the methodology used by the Central Bureau of Statistics (CBS), Sudan when forecasting the population?

Yes, there are notable differences between official population projections by the CBS Sudan and the 2025 COD-PS update by UNFPA:

(1) The 2025 COD-PS update is produced by sex and age for the most recent administrative boundary structure (188 localities), in alignment with the Common Operational Dataset on Administrative Boundaries (COD-AB). The CBS projections use an older administrative boundary structure with 178 localities.

(2) Official NSO projections usually only draw on census, surveys and vital registration and admin data on migration. Whereas, a COD-PS is guided by the “best available” humanitarian data standard. It therefore also engages other data sources in Sudan such as: the UNICEF MICS survey data, CBS thematic

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analyses on fertility and mortality, ACLED data on conflict-related mortality, IOM DTM data, and UNHCR refugee registration data.

Given the focus of the COD-PS on humanitarian and recovery planning within the internationally recognised borders of Sudan, the projected total reflected in this COD-PS excludes asylum seekers and refugees from Sudan recorded globally as of July 2025.

8. What quality assurance and validation was carried out on the 2024 COD-PS update?

The 2025 COD-PS update was cross-validated with comparable population estimates and projections at the national level (ADM-0 geographic area), at the state level (i.e. across 18 ADM-1 geographic areas of Sudan), and at the locality level (i.e. across the 188 ADM-2 geographic areas of Sudan). Cross-validation sources included the 2024 revision of the UN's World Population Prospects (for the ADM-0 geographic area), post-censal projections by the Central Bureau of Statistics, Sudan and population estimates by the Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) (for ADM-0, ADM-1 and ADM-2 geographical areas). Our cross-validation analysis notes differences between the 2025 COD-PS and estimates and projects by the CBS and IPC particularly for Khartoum and West Darfur – which reflects the substantial population mobility for those states but also notes the measurement uncertainty associated with population projections for localities within those states.

9. Where can I learn more about the technical details (e.g. input data and demographic estimation techniques) used for the 2024 COD-PS update?

Technical details about the different data sources and the methodological approach that was used to construct the 2025 COD-PS update are described in the Technical Accompanying Note to the 2025 COD-PS Update release.

10. What are the ongoing efforts by UNFPA to strengthen future COD-PS updates in Sudan?

UNFPA continues to support efforts to strengthen the use of population data and estimates in Sudan for disaster preparedness and operational humanitarian response by:

(1) Supporting annual efforts by the Government of Sudan and the Humanitarian Country Team to ensure that humanitarian assistance and recovery programmes draw on the best available baseline population and demographic data (including the 2025 COD-PS update);
(2) Continued collaborations with the Integrated Food Security Phase Classification (IPC) to further align COD-PS updates and IPC population estimates to support coordinated and effective food security emergency response;
(3) Advancing ongoing efforts with the CBS, Sudan to continue producing and

improving the population and demographic statistics in Sudan to facilitate people-centric decision-making and action across the humanitarian, peace development nexus.

11. How frequently are future updates planned to be developed?

Currently UNFPA and OCHA plan to update the COD-PS on an annual basis to support the humanitarian programme cycle and community-led recovery programmes across Sudan.

12. What are the terms and conditions of the 2024 UNFPA COD-PS Update?

The 2025 COD-PS update for Sudan is published on the OCHA Humanitarian Data Exchange for use by the Humanitarian Country Team, as well as national and international communities supporting humanitarian action in Sudan. It is a best available data product of the United Nations, and is therefore intended to support short-term humanitarian decision making.

13. Who can I contact to learn more about the 2024 COD-PS update?

For further information about this COD-PS update and related issues, please contact Dr. Faisal Abdallah Adam, Population & Development Programme Specialist (abdallahadam@unfpa.org), Mr Bruno Husquinet, Emergency Response Coordinator, UNFPA Sudan Country Office (husquinet@unfpa.org), or Mr Umar Yusuf, Information Management Officer, OCHA Sudan Country Office (yusuf7@un.org).

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